

# Hazrat Loot ﷺ

## *Loot and Ibraheem (Alaihimus Salām)*

Hazrat Loot ﷺ is a cousin of Nabi Ibraheem ﷺ and during his childhood he used to live under the care of Sayeduna Ibraheem ﷺ and grew up in the house of Nabi Ibraheem ﷺ.

## *After Returning from Egypt*

During Nabi Ibraheem (Alaihis Salām)'s *Hijrats* Hazrat Loot ﷺ and his wife always remained with him and while Ibraheem ﷺ was in Egypt they also were with him.

After Egypt Nabi Ibraheem ﷺ settled in Palestine while Nabi Loot chose to reside on the eastern side of the Jordan. There were two well known tribes in that area, viz Sodom and Ghamoorah.

## *The People of Loot*

When Nabi Loot ﷺ settled on the Eastern side of the Jordan, he found that the people of the area were involved with great evils and sinful practices. No other worldly evil was there which were not found among them. Apart from the other sins they were also involved with a very bad practice that to satisfy their sexual lusts, the men instead of resorting to females chose to do so with other males. Up to that time in

the world, this was not practised anywhere. This was a very unfortunate group of people who invented this evil act. And what is worse than that, they did not look upon it as a sin and they proudly proclaimed their being involved with it.

The Qur'ān states:

"And we sent Loot. He said to his people: "Do ye commit lewdness such as no people mention over committed before you.

For you practise your lasts on men in preference to women. You are indeed a people transgressing beyond bounds." (7:80—87)

### **Hazrat Loot عليه السلام Conveying the Message**

Nabi Loot عليه السلام preached to them about their shame less acts and iniquities and tried to get them towards a life of noble deeds and clean-living. In soft terms he tried to get them to heed his call explaining to them the results of previous nations as signs of warning but his call had no effect upon them. They replied by saying:

" And his people gave no answer but this; they said:

Drive them out of your city. These are indeed men who want to be clean and pure." (7:82)

This was a scornful and jeering manner of sarcastically playing the fool with the family of Nabi Loot عليه السلام. It was as if they said: If we are so shameless and evil and they are so clean and pure, there is no place for them in our city. Take them out. Expel them.

However Nabi Loot عليه السلام continued to advise them against those evils.

"Do you indeed approach men and cut off the highway.?"

And practise wickedness even in your councils?

But his people gave no answer but this; they said:

"Bring us the wrath of God if you tell the truth."

(29:29)

### ***Hazrat Ibraheem عليه السلام and the Angels***

While this was happening to Nabi Loot, Nabi Ibraheem عليه السلام had an experience. He was walking in the desert and saw three men ahead of him. Ibraheem عليه السلام was a humble and hospitable man. He was always prepared to entertain guests and seeing these three strangers, he was quite happy. He invited them to his house where he slaughtered a calf and roasted the meat and placed it before the guests. They refused to eat and then Nabi Ibraheem عليه السلام thought they were enemies who according to custom would refuse to partake of food. He was frightened as to what this was. When the guests saw his confusion and worry, they laughed and said:

"Do not fear. We are Angels of Allah and have been sent to destroy the people of Loot. We are going to Sodom."

When Nabi Ibraheem عليه السلام was convinced that they were not an enemy but were in fact Allah's Angels, his soft-heartedness, sympathetic feelings and his love and Mercy was stirred and on behalf of the people of Nabi Loot عليه السلام he began to dispute with the Angels: "How can you go and destroy the people among which there is such a chosen Messenger of Allah like Nabi Loot عليه السلام."

The Angels replied:

"We are well aware of who are there but Allah has decreed that the people of Loot because of their evil deeds, their obstinate rebellion, and their shamelessness and there insistance on evil, will be brought to destruction while Loot عليه السلام and his family will be saved except the wife of Loot عليه السلام who, having assisted in their evil deeds and their wrong beliefs, will be destroyed with them."

In any case Nabi Loot (*Alaihis Salām*)'s efforts of conveying the truth to his people had no effect upon them at all, and they remained involved with their evil deeds.

He said to them:

"Do you not consider the fact that for my efforts of conveying the message to you by night and by day, and for my continuous worries on your behalf, I do not ask of you any payment or reward or any present?

All I seek of my efforts is your salvation and your worldly and spiritual success. And yet you pay no attention at all."

Even this too had no effect upon them. They continued to threaten him with expulsion and stoning to death. When at last there was no positive response from them, the same happened to them as is stipulated in the Divine law of Retribution which in their case also meant destruction.

The Angels after leaving Nabi Ibraheem (*Alaihis Salām*)'s presence proceeded towards Sodom where they became the guests of Nabi Loot عليه السلام. They were all in the

forms of handsome, young men. When Nabi Loot عليه السلام saw them he was worried as to what his people would do to these young men. At that time he had not yet been informed that they were Angels.

Hazrat Loot عليه السلام was still struggling with this fear when the people came to know of the visitors and came to his house, demanding that he should hand the guests over to them. He tried his best to dissuade them from this demand and asked them: "Is there not one rational reasonable man amongst you? Why are you so insistent upon this curse of seeking satisfaction for your lust in the company of men, leaving aside the women folk.

Alas, if only I had 'a strong pillar' on which to rely?"

When the Angels saw his greatly troubled state, they said to him:

"Do not look at our outer forms and be so worried. We are Angels from Allah, bringing His punishment. Allah's decree in their regard is fixed and will not be warded off from them. You and your family will be saved and protected from the punishment, except your wife who was an assistant to them. She will not be with you."

At last the punishment of Allah came. At a sign from the Angels, Nabi Loot عليه السلام and his family left the town. His wife refused to be with them, and along the way out, she turned back and left them for return to Sodom.

Then in the later part of the night, a frightening cry turned the people upside down. Then an earthquake took place in which the upper crust of the earth was taken up and turned down upon them. From above stones rained down

upon them and destroyed the town so that not a sign of them was left. And so happened to them what happened to other rebellious disobedient nations.

### ***Ibraheem ؑ the Reformer***

From the various incidents related here apart from the fact that there are lessons and warnings for men, another important point that comes to the fore is the fact that the personality of Hazrat Ibraheem ؑ in the office of Prophet hood and messenger ship holds a position of superiority and seniority.

It is the true that every messenger of Allah is a caller towards the oneness of Allah and is an enemy of '*shirk*' and in the lives of all the messengers, these two points are common factors and spiritual invitations is firmly based upon these two points. However Nabi Ibraheem ؑ is the first person in this world who had to pass through very heavy trials and tests and had to combat great calamities and through all these trials he emerged successfully.

Just think for a moment. At very old age after numerous *Du'as* and numerous hopes and desires a child is born. The child is still in its infant stage when an order from Allah comes: "O Ibraheem ؑ, take the mother and child, cross the desert till you reach a valley in which there is no vegetation and leave them there."

Thereafter what happens? Did Ibraheem ؑ hesitate even for a moment before carrying out this order? Did he put forth any excuse? No, nothing, he immediately left to leave the mother and child there where the *Kabah* now stands. After that when the child reaches the age of reason and discernment when he has become the refreshment of the eyes to his parents, again comes and order to sacrifice

the child in the Name of Allah to show his obedience to Allah.

At such a time the most obedient one and the most righteous one will find himself some what in a dilemma with at least a bit of hesitation. And even though the revelation came in the form of a dream shown to him, he never tried to interpret it in a different way, but without any hesitation he took his beloved son the next day with the aim of carrying out the order, showing his faithfulness.

The third test was when Namrud, his father and the people passed a unanimous judgement against him that he should desist from preaching his message or he would be cast into a blazing fire. In the face of the unanimity among them one would expect Ibraheem (*Alaihis Salām*)'s feel to hesitate, but this never happened. He was as steadfast as a mountain as he continued to preach the truth and convey the message just as before. The enemies then did what they threatened to do and cast him into a blazing fire. In Ibraheem ؑ there was no difference in his dignified resolve and determination. However Allah frustrated all their plans and efforts as the flames of the fire were made 'cool and safe' for Ibraheem ؑ. Thereafter under the protection of Allah he continued to enlighten the servants of Allah and became even more diligent in conveying the message.

Apart from Ibraheem (*Alaihis Salām*)'s various tests and his steadfastness during those tests there is another speciality in the make up of Nabi Ibraheem ؑ and that is in the contrasting lives of *Shirk* and *Tauheed*, he produced such a special distinction which could only come forth from a messenger of Allah like himself. In his condemnation of idol worship and worship of the heavenly bodies, he clearly announced:

"For me, I have set my face firmly and truly towards Him who created the heavens and the earth and never shall I give partners unto God."

(6:79)

The meaning of this exclamation is that there are two views regarding Allah one the right view and secondly the wrong one.

The wrong view is this that it is believed that to acquire Allah's pleasure and to keep Him happy and to worship him properly, one will have to also worship the idols, and heavenly bodies for when these are pleased with us, they will make Allah be happy and pleased with us.

This belief is '*Shirk*' or '*Saubi'at*'. It means that all the worship which is for Allah alone and should be so, is shared also with others. That is the reality of '*Shirk*.'

In contrast to that is the correct path according to which one should have this belief that the only way of acquiring Allah's pleasure and satisfaction is that one should worship Him consider Him as the solver of our problems and the granter of our needs. He is the one in whose hands lie benefit and our harm or losses, our health and our illnesses, our poverty and our wealth, our sustenance in abundance or in inadequate amount, our life and our death. In other words One should accept that in all our affairs. He is the doer with complete freedom to do as He sees fit. Then also to acquire knowledge of His pleasure and displeasure one should act according to the teachings of the messengers whom He sent to this world. What this means is that to acquire Allah's pleasure and to attain nearness to Him there is no need to make the idols our intermediaries or intercessors, but just to worship Him alone. This is the belief of Islam and this is the upright religion.

This is the distinction Nabi Ibraheem  made between *Shirk* and *Imān*.

It became the foundation stone on which the following Prophets built until the final Prophet Muhammad  called his religion the "upright religion" and also named his follows 'Muslims.'

"And follow the way of Ibraheem  the true in faith."  
(4:125)

"Ibraheem  has named you Muslim and so also in this Qur'ān."  
(22:78)

This is the reason why there is this speciality in *Surah Ibraheem* that in it the advent of the Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*) and their personalities have been described as well as their general results and in it has been given the difference between those who obeyed and accepted their calls and invitation to guidance and those who rejected their invitations.

So bearing all that in mind, we say that among the Prophets and Messengers Nabi Ibraheem  has a position which we may call the Renovator of the Prophets.

### ***Lessons from the Various Incidents***

1. When a person has made a firm belief to enter his heart with certainty and that belief has become joined to his soul and been made a firm image within him, thoughts about that belief becomes so strong and steadfast that no happening on earth and no calamity however great will be able to remove it from his breast. He will enter a fire with pleasure or dive into a deep ocean without hesitation and fearlessly step onto the steps leading to crucifixion. The example of Nabi Ibraheem  is a living example thereof.

2. In support of the truth such arguments should be cited which will enter the hearts and minds of enemies and followers of falsehood so that they may not admit by tongue, but their hearts will be forced to declare, the truth reluctantly and at times the tongue will unintentionally declare. In the following verse this is what is meant: "And dispute with them in the best manner."
3. It is the way of the Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*) and Messengers that they do not utilize the arguments of logic in their disputes with people. Their arguments concern observations and things that are perceivable and they refer to simple rational things. Nabi Ibraheem (*Alaihis Salām*)'s debate with his people about idol worship and worship of the stars and heavenly bodies is a clear example thereof.
4. In the effort to prove a truth, if one makes use of for the sake of argument accepting his wrong belief, this does not mean one's acceptance of wrong beliefs. In debating it is a strategy used for the purpose of making the opponent see his mistake and admitting to it.  
Nabi Ibraheem ﷺ used this method in his debate with the general public the idol worshippers so that they had to admit that the idols could not hear and were unable to answer.
5. Even if one's father is an idol-worshipper and not prepared under any circumstances to discard idol worship then one should stay clear of his life of 'Shirk', but in worldly and spiritual affairs it will still be necessary to deal with him in a soft manner with kind advice. It will still not be permissible to act harshly towards him. The manner in which Nabi

Ibraheem  treated his father and the way in which Rasulullah  treated Abu Taalib are living examples thereof.

6. When a believer has faith in his heart and in his tongue, but he does not have a physical observation of that faith which grants complete certainty and then begs for such a demonstration, this is not doubt or disbelief but is in fact actual faith as was mentioned by Nabi Ibraheem , ("I do believe, but it is to set my heart at ease)."
7. If a person shows hospitality and generosity to guests without wishing to show off his hospitality to be known for it, this is a sign of kind-heartedness and of his noble character which is also known as generosity.

In some books a story is being told of Ibraheem (*Alaihis Salām*)'s generosity. Once he was standing in the desert awaiting the arrival of a guest. This was so because he was in the habit of never eating alone. From ahead of him he saw an old man coming along leaning on a walking stick with his back bent forward. As he approached Nabi Ibraheem  went forward to welcome him with pleasure and brought him home. They ate and when they had finished eating, Ibraheem  said: "Now let us express thanks to that Being who granted us all these favours:

"The old man, becoming angry replied: "I do not know who that one Being of yours is, I express thanks to my god, who is kept in my home-my idol."

This reply went down very badly with Ibraheem  and in response he quickly got rid of the old man and sent him forth.

However, not long after that Ibraheem عليه السلام felt sorrow in his heart for having got rid of the old man so quickly. He thought within himself. "The God whom I wanted him to express thanks to-His dealing with this man is such that during this old man's long life, He has continuously blessed him with His bounties and in spite of being displeased with his idol worship, He has not for one day closed down on him the doors of His sustenance. What right did you have, O Ibraheem عليه السلام, that this man has refused to accept your suggestion and you become angry and expel him from your house so quickly?"

Whether this incident is acceptable or not, it still serves to indicate the nobility of character which is an excellent example for others and his thoughts afterwards is in itself a good example.

8. When Allah chooses anyone for the purpose of spreading the truth, he enlightens their heart so much with His Noor that in their sight nothing can replace the love for truth and nothing else matters. The result is that from the beginning the preparedness and preparation is placed in them with the result that since their age of childhood they appear eminent and distinguished above their contemporaries. They willingly under go trials and tests in the path of truth and in patience and for bearance they set a fine example. The story of Hazrat Ismail عليه السلام is a good witness of this and holds many lessons for us.
9. Nabi Loot عليه السلام, although he was a nephew of Hazrat Ibraheem عليه السلام and a follower, was also endowed with prophethood and had been made Allah's ambassador Hence in Sodom and Gamoro he was made to suffer great hardships but in spite of that he remained patient

and steadfast and instead of calling upon the help of his uncle and family, relied only on Allah. He persevered in his efforts with complete resignation. Through that he reached the rank of the 'nearest ones to Allah' among the Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*).

# QASASUL AMBIYAA

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STORIES OF THE PROPHETS

Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy (Rah.)



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# Qasasul Ambiyaa

(Stories of the Prophets)

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## *Qasasul Ambiyaa*

The Holy Qur'ān does not relate historical facts merely for the sake of telling a story which is of historical value. Its main aim in relating happenings is to draw attention to the results, conclusions and deductions from these incidents so that they become a source of guidance for men and prove to be lessons for them that appeal to their minds and emotions that from these historical events, lessons should be derived. These lessons should convince them that the existence of Allah is an undeniable fact and that His Mighty Hand is playing a major role in the affairs of men. It should also bring to their notice that to follow the stipulations of His deen brings success and leads to salvation and is the way towards all progress. That is what Islām—the natural religion—is about.

*From: Qasasul Qur'ān*

## Preface

The most authentic and comprehensive work of Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy, *Qasasul Qur'ān* needs no introduction. However, the Manner in which our friend Sayed Tanzeem Hussain Saheb has brought forth an abridged version of a voluminous and bulky work he has undoubtedly, fulfilled one of the needs of this time. He has adopted such a method of abridgement whereby not only has he retained and mentioned every important fact in the lives of the Holy Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*) and other saintly personalities, which are of lessons to men, but also discussed in brought outline some other important matters. It is hoped that with Allah's grace, those persons who are occupied and busy at all times, will be able to derive adequate benefit from this work.

The great effort of Sayed Tanzeem Hussain in this old age of his is really something praiseworthy. May Allah reward him well for this great effort.

**Qari Sayed Rasheedul-Hasan Hussainy Nadwi**

*Imam and Khateeb*

Jama Masjid, New Town

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P5 Muharram, 1308 Hijri

## Publisher's Foreword

The respected personality of Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy is one of the most eminent Ulama of the Indo-Pak Sub-Continent. His most approved and well-known book, *Qasasul-Qur'ān* is considered to be a unique publication on this subject. The point that distinguishes it from other similar books is the fact that after every story, Maulana has made use of deep thought and reflection to present to the readers the lessons and points of guidance from the related episodes. Thus for the teachers and lecturers at *Deeni Madressas* and for preachers in mosques and students of deen the study and perusal of this book is of utmost benefit.

The original book appeared in four volumes with over 1800 pages of subject matter. Sayed Tanzeem Hussain Saheb has brought forth an abridged version there of in only 600 pages and this has been met with a verdict of approval from all academic circles, especially by virtue of the fact that he has fulfilled one of the most pressing needs of the time and by leaving aside unimportant discussions have given the busy and occupied ones also a chance to benefit from these work. May Allah reward him well.

## *Author's Foreword*

All praise be to Allah who has guided us with the Holy Book and revealed to us the Qur'ān in a clear Arabic language and in it. He related the best of stories as an admonition and a reminder for the believers. And May peace and blessings be upon the Most truthful and trustworthy Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, the messenger of Allah and seal of all the Prophets and upon his offspring, and companions who were all of them guiding stars for all the righteous ones.

Among the inimitable ways in which Allah has chosen for the sake of the guidance of men, is this that attention is drawn to the good and bad deeds of nations and the resultant fruits of such deeds of which they are reminded so that those deeds may be a lesson for men. For this reason those stories are not being related in a style as is generally done in history. The major aim is to convey the truth and to invite to Allah and with this in mind attention is only drawn to those aspects which furthers this objective. For this reason there is constant repetition so that these events can sink into the hearts and minds of listeners and they become attentive towards them. This sinking in and attentiveness can only be achieved if the same event is repeated in various ways and styles whereby sleeping faculties are woken up.

The Qur'ānic stories and events deal mostly with previous nations and the Messengers of Allah (*Alaihimus*

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*Salām*) who were sent to them and bit by bit other matters also become included there-in, mostly dealing with the arguments over good and bad and the battles between the friends of Allah and the friends of *Shaitan*, which in itself proves to be a great lesson and admonishment for me.

But, leaving others aside, there are today so few Muslims who derive benefit from Allah's last and perfect law-book, the Qur'ān, to fill our hearts with *Iman* and *Yaqeen*. After all it is Allah's law and we are commanded to implement its orders in our lives, Moreover we are required to ponder over its meanings as this Qur'ān is the means forwards acquiring success and salvation in both this world and the here after.

At the time of the Revelation of the Qur'ān, the Messenger of Allah became so distressed and defected at the enmity and opposition of the polytheists that he raised this complaint to Allah:

(5:25—30)

However, in this 15th century, if we should examine our hearts, we will find that in spite of our claims to be Muslims and believing the Qur'ān to be the word of Allah, how few are who have made this word of Allah the pattern for their lives and the model on which to base their lives, who read and recited with this aim in mind?

It was my aim, seeing this condition of my people and myself, to translate this great source of admonition into Urdu so that by presenting the translated version, the hearts of people will automatically become drawn to the original i.e., the Qur'ān and thereby acquire everlasting happiness.

In spite of my simple style of writing, care has been taken to confine myself to a few special points.

- (a) In this book the basis for all the stories is the Holy Qur'ān and the authentic *Hadith* and these have been further elucidated with historical facts.
- (b) Where there appears any contradiction or differences in the stories as told in the old testament and the Qur'ān, then with clear arguments an effort has been made either to reconcile the versions or with clear arguments to prove the truth as is expounded in the Qur'ān.
- (c) An effort has been made to point out the nonsensical Israili stories and where there have been nonsensical objections from enemies, these have in the light of the true facts been made clear for what they are.
- (d) In some special places there have been introduced some discussions on matters of disputes in *Tafseer* and *Hadith* and after discussing these the views of the saintly elders have been mentioned as a solution.
- (e) The facts concerning every Prophet ﷺ and in which chapter of the Qur'ān they are mentioned, has been gathered in one place.
- (f) Lastly, together with all the above points, a special heading of "Results and lessons", is introduced, giving the actual objective of this book and its main purpose viz., admonition and warning. Special attention is drawn to this aspect.

*Servant of the Millat*

**Muhammad Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy**

22 Rajab, 1360 Hijri

## Translator's Foreword

For me as the translator of this book by Maulana Hifzur Rahman is a great honour. Throughout my student days in Darul Uloom Deoband in India, Maulana Hifzur Rahman or as we know him then as the *Mujahid-e-Millat* was one of the most respected leaders of the Muslim community. We used to flock to listen to his most interesting lectures. And as the general secretary of the *Jamiatul-Ulama*, and a M.P. he was also a great 'Alim (scholar) as can be gauged from this book *Qasasul Ambiya* (Tales of the Prophets) which entailed great research. I can remember whenever the students were confronted with any problem in the lives of any of the prophets, they always took refuge in Maulana's book for answers. I took upon it as a great honour in being in some small manner associated with Maulana's scholarship, even though this is an abridged version of the original book. But I must also state that I found great difficulty in translating this book because of the exceptionally high quality of the Urdu language used in the book.

I hope that the English translation of Maulana Hifzur Rahman's scholarly work will also be of great benefit to the English-speaking people. I just hope that I have been able to do justice to the original thoughts of the author.

**Yusuf Karaan**  
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